LANDLORDLEDGER · BUILD IT SERIES · FREE CHECKLIST Property: _____ Date: _____

ANNUAL WATER-DAMAGE WALKTHROUGH

One walk, once a year, about an hour. The $5 fixes that prevent the $5,000 repairs.

OUTSIDE

- [ ] Caulk around windows, doors, and siding cracks: reseal anything hard, cracked, or pulling away
- [ ] Gutters clear; downspouts dump water at least 4–6 ft away from the foundation
- [ ] Soil slopes away from the house (no puddles against the foundation after rain)
- [ ] Roof from the ground: missing or lifted shingles, loose flashing at chimney and vents
- [ ] Hose spigots don't drip; hoses disconnected before the first freeze

ATTIC

- [ ] Flashlight on the roof boards: dark stains, wet spots, or daylight where it shouldn't be
- [ ] Insulation is dry and not packed against the soffit (eave) vents
- [ ] Roof vents are open and not blocked by insulation, nests, or debris
- [ ] **BONUS: the #1 hidden attic culprit most landlords miss: revealed in Build It · Ep. 2**

BATHROOMS

- [ ] Caulk where the tub or shower meets the tile; scrape out and reseal any gaps or dark spots
- [ ] Grout has no cracks; no soft spots in the floor around the tub or toilet
- [ ] Toilet doesn't rock; no stains at the base; supply line is braided, not old plastic
- [ ] Exhaust fan runs and holds a square of toilet paper against the grille
- [ ] Under the sink: dry cabinet floor, no drips at the shut-off valves

KITCHEN & LAUNDRY

- [ ] Under the sink and behind the dishwasher: dry, no swelling in the cabinet floor
- [ ] Fridge ice-maker line: no kinks, drips, or brittle plastic tubing
- [ ] Washer hoses: braided steel, no bulges; replace rubber hoses about every 5 years

WATER HEATER & HVAC

- [ ] Water heater: no rust or puddles at the base; relief valve pipe runs down toward the floor
- [ ] Note the water heater age (tank units commonly last about 8–12 years)
- [ ] AC condensate drain line and pan clear; sump pump (if any) turns on when tested

RED FLAGS: CALL A PRO

- [ ] Musty smell, bubbling paint, warped floors, ceiling stains, or a water bill that jumped
- [ ] Any visible mold larger than a small patch, or wood that is soft when you press it

YOUR KIT: flashlight · tube of silicone caulk (~$5) · utility knife · toilet paper square · phone for photos

Tip: photograph every item each year. Same angle, same spot, so changes jump out next time.

General information only, not professional advice. Have a licensed pro inspect your property.
Free to use and share · Build It series, Ep. 1: "The $5 material that destroys houses"